

CORPORAL PUNISHMENT

It is the policy of the Lone Grove Board of Education to administer corporal punishment only as a last resort after other reasonable corrective measures have been used without success. At the beginning of the school year, parents and legal guardians will be provided the opportunity to request the nonadministration of corporal punishment to their children. (See also Form FOB-E1.) **However, under no circumstances shall any child in DHS custody or any student on an individualized educational program (IEP) be administered corporal punishment.**

Corporal punishment must be administered only in the presence of another professional, certificated staff member, preferably an administrator. Careful documentation of each occasion shall be made by the teacher or the administrator or both. Such documentation will identify the student and set forth the behavior necessitating the punishment; the person who administered the punishment; and the name of witnesses.

Under no circumstances shall other students or non-certificated personnel observe the administration of corporal punishment. The student shall be carefully advised of the nature of the rule infraction for which the punishment is being administered.

If a parent or legal guardian has requested that corporal punishment not be administered to the student, alternative discipline will be considered and may include suspension from school.

The following steps will be followed by all district personnel when corporal punishment---paddling---is warranted.

1. When misbehavior occurs, a student is first talked to and warned that if the behavior continues, a paddling will be given.
2. If a paddling is administered, the following procedure is followed:
 - a. Explain to the student why he is being paddled.
 - b. It is done in the principal's office.
 - c. It is witnessed by the principal or another teacher.
 - d. No more than three (3) swats will be given, and punishment shall not be given by a teacher who is angry or upset.
 - e. A discipline report is filled out and kept on file until the end of the school year.
 - f. The parent will be contacted after the paddling by telephone or letter.
3. In some situations, the parent may be contacted first, and the problem discussed before any action is taken.
4. If parents do not want their children paddled and prefer other forms of punishment, they must sign a letter to that effect each year and give it to the school principal.

**REFERENCE: 10 O.S. §7115
70 O.S. §6-113.1
70 O.S. §6-114
70 O.S. §13-116
Accreditation Standard 210:15--13-9**